

"tumblelogs", Tumblr took the blog form and made it its own. Its interface is easy to use and accessible, with apps for iPhone and BlackBerry devices. In fact, many believe that Facebook increased the character limit for status updates in response to Tumblr's growing popularity. Of course it doesn't offer as extensive a feature-set as Facebook does, but it's certainly the easiest to use micro-blogging site around for those less interested in Likes and Pokes!

LinkedIn

Digital head-hunting

Although a lot of people may network with colleagues and clients on Facebook as well, LinkedIn is the professional's choice for business networking. Facebook is looked



LinkedIn means business - and it doesn't disappoint

upon as too informal, as compared to LinkedIn, especially in corporate culture.

On LinkedIn, Friends are "Connections", and how well you know someone depends on how short that connection is. For example, direct connections are most likely colleagues or your direct clients, while second-degree connections are sort of like friends-of-a-friend. Third-degree connections are friends stemming from

second-degree ones, and so on. The major advantage of LinkedIn is that you will meet professionals from all over the globe, and it's all work-related networking - no more stupid baby pictures and dumb wall posts to sort through. This is why it's also important that you stay serious on LinkedIn, to avoid making a fool of yourself on a global corporate scale.

Apart from being able to connect with industry bigwigs, there's a very HR (human resources) side to LinkedIn. For example, you can ask people you've worked with at any time of your life to give you a "Recommendation", much like you might do for a CV, but this will be visible to hundreds of thousands of potential clients and employers who form a part of your Connection chain. These days, it's a safe bet to assume that HR representatives at a company you've applied to are looking for your LinkedIn profile.

It's also a great way to find new job opportunities, get new ideas, and interact with some really intelligent and successful folks. Using LinkedIn Answers, you could ask the LinkedIn community any questions you have, and you get more credible answers from qualified professionals. It's sort of what Zuckerberg tried to do with Quora.

Yes, LinkedIn doesn't have Farmville, all of your friends or the best place to find a date, but thanks to tight-knit policies, it's a great resource for those serious about their careers. The amount of friends, dates and fun you have (in the real world) are usually directly proportional to your success. Remember that the next time you get online.

Flickr

The next level of photography

Cross a microblogging site with a social network, throw in some amateur photography/videography for flavour and garnish with the creativity that users display on sites such as deviantArt. Now add a side order of e-commerce by way of stock photography royalties and you



Flickr is a great platform for amateur and professional photographers alike

get Flickr. A site that has more than 32 million users and 6+ billion photographs.

Owned by Yahoo!, free accounts are capped to uploading a maximum of 300 MB of images and two videos every month, and "Pro" accounts get unlimited bandwidth (for a price). Tagging is taken to a greater degree with sets of tags or tag-clouds for images. Results can be geo-tagged onto maps, and can then be shared online - providing people with a view from the ground. This idea has been taken further with OpenStreetMap where cities such as Sydney and Tokyo have been mapped thusly.

If you're serious about photography, and are unhappy with Facebook's limited features for albums, Flickr is the place to be.

Twitter

The #revolution begins here

Twitter was the go-to tool for status updates and short messages before Facebook. In fact, for quick updates, breaking news, and for the twitterati, it's still the only place to be. With over 300 million users tweeting every day, including perhaps every celebrity you'll want to follow, it's easy to see what the fuss is all about.

It's also the most promising mobile-friendly, social network, because of the 120-character limit. From celebrities to religious figures and presidents of countries, every one's on Twitter, and you can be sure to find what the world is currently talking about by looking at the topics that are "trending" on Twitter.

Although it really doesn't replace any of the other social networking sites, it's still a great way to network and keep yourself updated with what's making headlines, what's hot and what's not across the globe, or even in your city! 



Twitter's simplicity and addictiveness attracts everyone, including celebrities.